

Graphics card around ₹8,000

Please recommend a suitable graphics card in the range of 8000 on the following configuration: Pentium Dual Core, 2 GB RAM and with a mainboard Acer G31T-M5

Debadyuti Bhattacharya

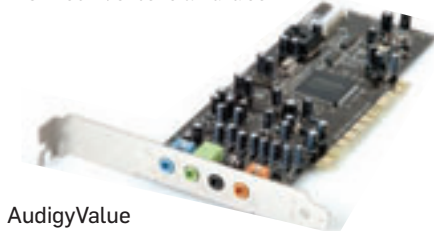
A graphics card in that price range will be overkill for your configuration. It is recommended that you upgrade your system if you're looking for a graphics card such as the GeForce GTS250 or Radeon 5750. The processor will be somewhat of a bottleneck and you won't find frame rates going up beyond a certain point. If you have no plans of upgrading, purchase a somewhat cheaper GeForce GTS240 for the time being.

Sound card for new speakers

I recently purchased a Philips 5.1 surround speaker (Model no - MMS 5130). It has three pin to plug into the processor. But My sound card is 2.1 channel. So please suggest me a sound card which has three point which I can plug in the speakers pins. All are 3.5 mm jack. My budget is within ₹2,000 - 3,000.

Subham Gartia

Most sound cards on motherboards over the years have come with 5.1 audio outputs. Ensure that your card isn't one of them. Some speakers use RCA connectors to input audio to the amplifier/woofer. If that's the case, you can simply purchase these 3.5 mm - RCA converters and use



AudigyValue

those speakers. Few or almost no sound cards come with RCA connectors. If you're looking for a 5.1 sound capable sound card, look at the Creative Sound Blaster Audigy Value 7.1 card. It should be priced around ₹1,800.

PC or graphics card upgrade?

I need your help in selecting a graphics card for my PC. Also suggest some game titles that we could play. Please do not suggest gory titles. I am a doctor and my son is 11 years old.

My budget is between ₹4,000. I can stretch it to a maximum of ₹6,500. I read about the Graphics cards in the July issue of Digit.

My PC is a low cost Zotac 610i value Motherboard, with a 400W power supply. It has one PCIe x16 slot, Pentium-D 2 GHz, 3 GB DDR2 533 RAM, 80 GB, IDE HDD, onboard NVIDIA Geforce 7050 running Windows 7 Professional.

I need to know whether my PC suitable for a graphics card upgrade?

We prefer games of the milder kind. For example, *Heart of Darkness*, *Road Rash*, *NFS*, and *Trine* to name a few.

However, the games we have been playing have been restricted due to hardware limitations in our PC.

We really loved Trine. It's the latest game we liked, but cannot play it beyond 640x480 resolution, and so we cannot truly enjoy the game.

We look forward to your suggestions.

Dr. Vijay & Jacob

Considering your requirements, we would suggest going in for a GeForce GT240 graphics card for the gaming if you aren't planning to upgrade anytime soon. It won't improve performance by a whole lot because of the older processor. An entire system overhaul seems overdue. If that's the plan, a graphics card in the price range of ₹6,000 - ₹8,000 would be the way to go.

Some games with little or no gore that you must try *FIFA 2010*, *Pro Evolution Soccer 2009/2010*, *Braid*, *World of Goo*, *Sins of a Solar Empire*, *Spore* and *Overlord*.

Need to purchase a new monitor

I am planning to buy a new Full HD monitor. I have selected two Dell monitors. These are as the Dell ST2210 and the Dell ST2220L.

Of these two, which one is better? Also, tell me the price of these monitors.

Further, I want to buy a graphics card. My budget is ₹5,000. However, the monitor should have an HDMI port. I am not too much into gaming, but I need it for movie viewing and normal stuff.

My PC configuration is Intel Dual core processor on original Intel 945 GNT Motherboard with 2 GB RAM.

Anupam Parekh

The two displays are almost identical to each other. The Dell ST2220 looks like a newer model with the same specifications. For accurate prices, you should contact Dell from their web site or their customer care numbers. For under Rs. 5,000, you can find a GeForce GT240 graphics card.

Laptop for around ₹25,000

I admire your magazine and have never been let down by the Digit team. The thing is, I want to buy a laptop that I would be using for general operations such as surfing the net, writing documents, watching movies and listening to music. My budget is around ₹25,000. I am totally against using Compaq and HCL laptops. Please exclude them.

This is urgent and it would be very kind of you if you can reply via mail.

Pratik

Look for the Acer Aspire 4736Z model. It should fall in the price range.

Best tablet for media?

I want to buy an Android based tablet. It should have Wi-Fi connectivity, 720p video playback (if 1080p is available then I would prefer that), full Flash support, large screen at least 7-inch (10.1-inch is recommended). The tablet should have the latest version of Android.

Basically, I just want to watch high definition movies and have a rich web experience. I am not limited by budget. Please suggest accordingly.

Abhishek Kumar

The OlivePad VT100 is the only one available in India. It's not particularly great. If budget is no issue, the iPad is your best option. You'll have to get it shipped from the US.